

Data Sources and Migration Measures

Panel A: Data Source Comparison

IRS Statistics of Income (SOI)

- + Near-universal coverage (all tax filers)
- + Unambiguous residence (tax return address)
- + County-to-county flows with AGI
- No individual characteristics (age, educ.)
- Available only through 2022 (2 post years)
- Aggregate: county-pair is unit of observation

American Community Survey (ACS)

- + Individual-level data with demographics
- + Available through 2024 (4 post years)
- + Enables DiD with education as treatment proxy
- 1% sample: small N, measurement error
- County suppressed for small counties (389 obs.)
- Residence definition may capture temp. moves

Panel B: Migration Measures

Measure	Definition	IRS	ACS	Used In
Individual migration (M_{hit})	1 if person h moved in/out of county i in year t	—	☐ (389 counties)	DiD
County-pair flows (M_{ijt})	# individuals/returns/AGI from county i to j in t	☐	☐ (limited)	PPML
County migration rates (M_{it})	In-, out-, net in-migration rate for county i in t	☐	☐	SDID

Key: County migration rates can be computed from both sources, enabling head-to-head comparison via SDID before using source-specific methods.

Units of Migration

AGI (income)

IRS: AGI
ACS: Household income

Returns (households)

IRS: Returns
ACS: Households

Exemptions (individuals)

IRS: Exemptions
ACS: Individuals

Notes: IRS data covers tax years 2016–2022. ACS data covers 2016–2024. AGI = Adjusted Gross Income.